BOARD OF SUPERVISORS

AGENDA DATE: July 7, 2026

TO: Board of Supervisors

FROM: Kevin Yeager, Deputy Chief Administration

REVIEWED BY: Jason Weber, Fire Chief, Marin County Fire

SUBJECT: A hearing for County Service Area 27 calling for an election for the passage of the Ross Valley Paramedic Authority Four-Year Special Parcel Tax for the Tax Cycle 2027-2031, to be consolidated with November 3, 2026, General Election on a measure to continue the special tax for paramedic services; adopting the Resolution with the intended ballot language in Exhibit A and B; and authorizing the Marin County Elections Department to take appropriate action.

RECOMMENDATION: Authorize the Board President to execute the Resolution calling for an election in County Service Area 27 for the continuation of the Ross Valley Paramedic Authority (RVPA) four-year special parcel tax from July 1, 2027 through June 30, 2031; and consolidate the election with the Statewide General Election on November, 3, 2026; and authorize and direct the Deputy Clerk of the Board of Supervisors to file a certified copy of this Resolution with the Registrar of Voters for the County of Marin, and authorize and direct the Marin County Elections Department to take appropriate actions to complete the process for placing the measure on the November 3, 2026 ballot including publishing the full measure as found in Exhibit A in the Voter‘s Guide.

SUMMARY: The Ross Valley Paramedic Authority (RVPA) Joint Powers Authority, all eight RVPA member agencies are scheduling an election for November 3, 2026, to consider an increase to the paramedic tax cap. At a special board meeting on April 20, 2026, the RVPA Board approved a recommendation that member agencies place the RVPA special parcel tax measure on the November 2026 ballot. The measure would establish maximum tax rates and a four-year term covering FY2027-28 through FY2030-31. County Service Area 27 is one of these areas the voters will decide if they approve the renewal of the special parcel tax.

DISCUSSION / BACKGROUND: The Ross Valley Paramedic Authority has provided responsive, high-quality Fire Department paramedic and pre-hospital emergency medical care to the community for over 40 years. One of the oldest regional partnerships in Marin County, RVPA is a Joint Powers Authority formed in 1982 among the Cities/Towns of Corte Madera, Larkspur, Fairfax, Ross, and San Anselmo; the Kentfield Fire Protection District; the Sleepy Hollow Fire Protection District; and the County of Marin ("Member Agencies") to provide paramedic services in and across the Member Agencies' jurisdictions through a single public agency.

RVPA is funded primarily through special parcel tax revenues. Every four years the voters within each Member Agency's jurisdiction vote to fund the parcel tax for another four-year period. Voters have consistently approved the RVPA tax. The current tax expires on June 30, 2027. To maintain funding, each Member Agency must place the parcel tax on the ballot as a local ballot measure, which must be approved by two-thirds of the voters.

Under the proposed tax, each taxable residential unit is taxed at a rate of up to $107.50, and every 1000 square feet of developed nonresidential property, and is adjusted up to $4 per year. The current approved tax rate applies to residential units and every 1500 square feet for nonresidential uses through the end of fiscal year 2027. The proposed tax would apply to developed, non-residential uses at every 1000 square feet. Additionally, the current adjustment rate would change from $3 to up to $4 per year.

During the period of the tax, the governing body of each Member Agency annually confirms the tax by adoption of a Resolution. RVPA recommends the annual increase in tax within the limit every year based on the financial need of RVPA to maintain its service. The tax is not automatically increased by $4 per year but rather may be up to that amount depending on the financial condition of RVPA.
Below are the tax rates:

- FY 26-27 (current) $103.50
- FY 27-28 Up to: $107.50
- FY 28-29 Up to: $111.00
- FY 29-30 Up to: $114.50
- FY 30-31 Up to: $118.00

The proposed ballot language is as follows:

> *To maintain rapid 9-1-1 emergency response times and preserve the number of on-duty paramedics ready to respond to accidents/medical emergencies, shall the Ross Valley Paramedic Authority measure be adopted continuing for four years the paramedic services special tax of up to $107.50/ residential living unit or 1,000 square feet of developed nonresidential property, adjusted up to $4/ year, generating approximately $84,000 annually, with annual audits, public spending disclosure and all funds for local paramedic services?*

Upon passage of the RVPA tax measure by two-thirds of voters, the parcel tax becomes effective ten days after it is declared by the County of Marin Board of Supervisors for the term of the next tax cycle. The Resolution also requests that the Marin County Board of

Supervisors consolidate the local election with the Statewide General Election on November 3, 2026.

POLICY FRAMEWORK: The Board of Supervisors has reviewed and approved this request from RVPA to schedule an election back on November 8, 2022, at the June 14, 2022 regular board meeting.

EQUITY IMPACT SUMMARY: The proposed adjustment to the paramedic tax cap is intended to support equitable access to high-quality emergency medical services for all residents within the Ross Valley Paramedic Authority service area. Maintaining reliable paramedic response and advanced life support capabilities benefits the community, with particular importance for individuals who may experience greater barriers to timely medical care, including seniors, people with disabilities, and households with limited resources. The measure is structured to ensure that service levels are sustained consistently across all neighborhoods, supporting fair and equitable emergency response regardless of geography or socioeconomic status.

COMMUNICATIONS & COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT: Public notification has been carried out in accordance with the Brown Act. Standard notice protocols were followed through the Clerk of the Board and the County Executive Office, including posting of the agenda, publication of the staff report, and public access to supporting materials. RVPA Board adheres to the same standards and protocols.

PERFORMANCE MEASURES: N/A

CONTRACT RENEWALS / PERFORMANCE OUTCOMES: N/A

CONTRACT RISKS: N/A

CEQA ANALYSIS: This action does not constitute a “project” under the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) pursuant to Public Resources Code §21065 and CEQA Guidelines §§ 15060(c) and 15378. Therefore, it is not subject to environmental review, documentation, or public notice requirements under CEQA.

FISCAL, FACILITY & STAFFING ANALYSIS: There is no impact to the County General Fund associated with placing this measure on the ballot. If approved by two-thirds of voters, the special parcel tax would continue for four years beginning July 1, 2027, and is estimated to generate approximately $84,000 in year-one local funding for County Service Area 27. Revenues from the special tax would be used exclusively for paramedic and/or emergency medical services, deposited in a separate fund, and restricted from use for other County purposes. No additional County facility or staffing impacts are anticipated.

ALTERNATIVES: If the Board does not approve placing the RVPA parcel tax measure on the November 2026 ballot, the existing tax will expire on June 30, 2027, resulting in the loss of a significant funding source used exclusively for paramedic and pre-hospital emergency medical services.

Without renewal, RVPA would face substantial budget reductions that could lead to fewer on-duty paramedics, slower 911 response times, reduced advanced life-support capabilities, and limitations on maintaining necessary training and equipment.

ESTIMATED TIME (in minutes): 5 minutes

ATTACHMENTS: Draft Resolution with Exhibits A & B